STEP 3

Solution Ideation & Prioritization

Selecting a focused product direction for honest commitment closure

Fireflies.ai Product Management Launchpad Capstone

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Decision objective: compare solution options against the problem framing, select no more than two core solutions, and make assumptions and trade-offs explicit.

1. Executive summary

Step 2 framed the opportunity as a possible continuity gap between a commitment discussed in a meeting and an explicitly verifiable outcome. The research is directional: it does not establish one dominant root cause. Therefore, ideation should address the end-to-end continuity problem without assuming that reminders, ownership ambiguity, or extraction quality alone explain unresolved commitments.

Recommended initial direction: (1) owner-confirmed commitment handoff, and (2) lightweight explicit resolution within Fireflies Tasks. These are product hypotheses to prototype and test, not proven interventions. They are intentionally narrow: clarify who has accepted responsibility and make the eventual outcome explicit without building a replacement project-management system.

2. Prioritization principles

- Address the defined outcome: an eligible commitment is resolved within 14 days only when explicitly marked done, reassigned with acceptance by the new owner, or deliberately dropped.
- Respect ownership consent: a person mentioned in a meeting is not automatically a committed owner. Ownership must be accepted or clarified.
- Fit existing behavior: keep the workflow in Fireflies and connect to existing work tools where feasible rather than creating another full task platform.
- Minimize effort and notification load: prefer event-triggered, contextual actions over repeated generic reminders.
- Support honest closure: allow blocked work to remain unresolved and allow deliberate dropping as a legitimate terminal state.
- Protect trust: team-level visibility should not become individual surveillance or reward superficial status changes.
- Prefer testable, reversible changes that build on existing commitment extraction.

3. Solution space: 12 options

Option	What it does	Potential value and trade-off
1. Owner confirmation before assignment is finalized	Makes suggested ownership explicit and asks the proposed owner to accept, decline, or clarify.	Directly addresses consent and handoff ambiguity; adds a small confirmation step.
2. Explicit resolution controls in Tasks	Allow Done, Reassign (with new-owner acceptance), and Deliberately dropped; keep Blocked as unresolved.	Maps UI states to the North Star definition; risks status gaming if treated as a target.
3. Commitment context card	Show source meeting, original wording, description, due date, and completion criteria together.	Reduces context hunting; risks clutter if too much information is mandatory.
4. Due-date and completion-criteria clarification	Prompt for missing date or success criteria when needed, without forcing invented values.	Can reduce interpretation mismatch; may add friction and false precision.
5. Blocker and dependency update	Let owners flag a blocker and name a dependency or next update.	Improves transparency; blocked status must not count as resolved.
6. Contextual reminders	Send limited reminders near a due date or after inactivity, with snooze and notification controls.	May prompt action; can create overload and cannot fix unclear expectations.
7. Reassignment workflow	Allow owner to propose reassignment and require new owner to accept.	Supports legitimate handoffs; overlap with option 1, so keep it part of owner confirmation.
8. Deliberate-drop rationale	Allow a commitment to be dropped with a short reason or optional note.	Makes non-action explicit and honest; must not pressure people to drop work to improve metrics.
9. Existing-tool links / integrations	Attach or link Jira, CRM, ticket, document, or tracker references to a commitment.	Reduces duplicate work; integrations can be costly and inconsistent across tools.
10. Manual task creation with context	Create a task in Fireflies with description, assignee (optional), due date, priority, meeting link, completion criteria, notes, and supporting document links/attachment metadata.	Covers work not extracted from meetings; expands scope and can duplicate existing task systems.
11. Team-level unresolved commitment view	Show aggregate unresolved/blocked items and age, with context and access controls.	Helps coordination; risks surveillance or creating a new dashboard to manage.
12. Commitment closure summary after meeting	Offer a compact review of captured commitments, proposed owners, and missing fields before the meeting record is finalized.	Can catch capture issues early; may increase meeting-end friction and depends on extraction quality.

4. Prioritization method

Options are scored directionally using a lightweight RICE-inspired rubric because reliable reach, impact, and effort data are not yet available. Scores are comparative product judgment, not empirical findings. Reach, impact, confidence, and effort use 1–5 scales; confidence reflects how well the option maps to the framed problem and constraints, not proof of outcome improvement. Priority index = Reach × Impact × Confidence ÷ Effort.

Option	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	Index
Owner confirmation before assignment is finalized	5	5	3	2	37.5
Explicit resolution controls in Tasks	5	5	4	2	50.0
Commitment context card	4	4	3	2	24.0
Due-date / completion-criteria clarification	4	3	3	2	18.0
Blocker and dependency update	4	3	3	2	18.0
Contextual reminders	4	3	2	2	12.0
Reassignment workflow (standalone)	3	4	3	3	12.0
Deliberate-drop rationale	3	4	4	2	24.0
Existing-tool links / integrations	4	4	2	5	6.4
Manual task creation with context	3	3	2	3	6.0
Team-level unresolved view	3	3	2	3	6.0
Post-meeting closure summary	4	4	3	3	16.0

Interpretation: the score supports a shortlist, not an automatic decision. Owner confirmation and explicit resolution controls score well because they map closely to the definition of honest closure and can be tested without committing to broad integrations. Deliberate dropping should be implemented as part of the resolution controls, and reassignment acceptance should be part of owner confirmation rather than a separate core solution.

5. Recommended initial direction: two core solutions

Core solution A — Owner-confirmed commitment handoff

Proposed experience

- Extracted or manually created commitment includes the source meeting/context and a proposed owner only when the evidence supports suggesting one.
- The proposed owner receives a lightweight request to accept, decline, or clarify the assignment; mentioning someone in a meeting is not treated as acceptance.
- If the current owner proposes reassignment, the new owner must accept before the reassignment counts as resolved.
- Where no owner can be inferred confidently, leave the item unassigned and make clarification easy rather than guessing.

Why prioritize it: it makes responsibility explicit without assuming consent, and supports a trustworthy handoff. Main trade-off: confirmation introduces a small amount of friction and may leave some commitments unassigned until clarified.

Core solution B — Lightweight explicit resolution in Fireflies Tasks

Proposed experience

- Keep commitment follow-through in the existing Fireflies Tasks workflow rather than launching a separate project-management surface.

- Provide explicit terminal actions: Done, Reassign (then await new-owner acceptance), and Deliberately dropped. Keep Blocked / Waiting as non-terminal states.
- Preserve the meeting source, task context, due date where known, and completion criteria where useful.
- Support low-friction updates and restrained, user-controlled reminders; do not require a narrative for every state change.

Why prioritize it: it directly encodes the capstone definition of resolution and makes the outcome measurable. Main trade-off: a resolution control can be misused for superficial closure, so guardrails and qualitative validation are necessary.

6. Why not prioritize the alternatives first?

Alternative	Why it is not a core solution for the first iteration	When to revisit
More reminders	A reminder cannot repair a missing, unclear, or unaccepted commitment; additional reminders may create overload.	If research or experiments show that eligible, understood commitments remain open primarily due to lack of timely prompts.
Broad integrations	Potentially useful, but high effort and dependent on the existing tool mix; not yet supported by verified demand data.	After identifying the most common tools and validating a narrow integration with a pilot cohort.
Manager dashboard	Could improve visibility but risks surveillance and may optimize for reporting rather than genuine closure.	If managers and ICs validate a shared coordination need and access/aggregation guardrails are clear.
Mandatory due dates / success criteria	Can create false precision when a deadline or definition of done was never agreed.	Use selective prompts when missing information blocks execution; allow unknown values.
Manual task creation as a standalone core solution	Useful as a complementary path for commitments that are missed by extraction or originate outside meetings, but broader task creation may expand the product into another task manager.	Evaluate as a supporting capability in prototype tests; do not let it displace the two core closure mechanisms.

7. How manual task creation fits

Manual task creation is included as a supporting capability to evaluate, not as a third core solution or a research finding. It can provide a fallback when a commitment is not captured from a meeting or when a user needs to add work with a document, link, or other context. A proposed task form may include title, description, optional assignee, due date, priority, related meeting, completion criteria, notes, and supporting document links or attachment metadata.

Trade-off: this improves coverage but risks duplicate entry and scope expansion. The prototype should make it clear that attachment metadata or links in a prototype do not prove that files are persistently stored, parsed, or summarized. The production design should reuse existing task and document workflows where possible.

8. Success criteria and experiment hypotheses

Hypothesis to test	Primary observation	Guardrail
Owner confirmation improves clarity of responsibility.	Share of proposed assignments accepted, declined, or clarified within a defined window; time to accepted owner.	Do not assign work to a person without acceptance; monitor unassigned and declined rates.
Explicit resolution controls improve verifiable closure.	14-day resolution rate for eligible commitments, by cohort and resolution type.	Audit a sample of Done / Dropped events for honesty; monitor reopenings and rapid status reversals.
Context preservation reduces clarification effort.	User-reported ability to explain what was agreed and what counts as complete; clarification events if instrumented.	Do not force missing dates or success criteria; preserve source context.
Contextual reminders help without burden.	Resolution after a reminder compared with a suitable control or phased rollout.	Notification opt-outs, dismissals, complaints, and reminders per user.
Manual task creation fills genuine capture gaps.	Share of manually created tasks linked to real work and later reaching an explicit outcome.	Duplicate-task reports, creation abandonment, and extra time to create a task.

These are hypotheses, not promised effects. The North Star remains the 14-day commitment resolution rate. Experiments should use clear eligibility rules and a comparison design where feasible; the current interview sample alone cannot establish causal impact.

9. Key risks and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Ownership is assigned without consent	Use proposed-owner states; require acceptance before assignment/handoff is considered complete.
Users mark work Done or Dropped just to improve the metric	Keep honest terminal states distinct; audit samples, track reopenings, and never reward completion volume alone.
Notification fatigue	Use contextual triggers, user controls, digest options where appropriate, and frequency caps.
Feature duplicates project-management tools	Keep Fireflies focused on commitment continuity and link to existing systems instead of rebuilding boards and advanced planning.
Managers use the experience for surveillance	Default to task context and coordination; limit unnecessary individual ranking and make visibility rules explicit.
Missing data leads to false certainty	Allow unassigned owners, unknown dates, blocked states, and incomplete criteria where appropriate.
Research signal is not representative	Validate across stakeholder types and trace concrete commitments to outcomes before scaling.

10. Decision log

Decision	Rationale	Open risk / validation needed
Prioritize owner-confirmed handoff	Supports accepted ownership and legitimate reassignment without presuming consent.	Test confirmation friction and what to do when the proposed owner does not respond.
Prioritize explicit resolution controls in Tasks	Aligns product states to the capstone definition of honest resolution.	Test whether users understand Done, Reassigned, Dropped, and Blocked consistently.
Keep manual task creation as supporting capability	Provides a fallback path for work not extracted from meetings or added later with context.	Validate whether users need this within Fireflies or prefer creating tasks in their existing tool.
Defer broad integrations and manager dashboards	Effort and trust risks are high relative to current evidence.	Revisit after tool-distribution and stakeholder validation.

11. Step 3: Conclusion

The recommended direction is a deliberately small intervention: establish accepted ownership, then make honest closure easy to record in the workflow users already have. Supporting context and manual task creation can improve usability, but should not turn the product into a new general-purpose task manager. The next step is to translate this direction into a mini PRD and clickable experience, then test whether people understand and trust the proposed states before making impact claims.